Northstar Company Policies

Sample employee handbook for RAG practice

About this document

This fictional sample document has ten numbered sections, each beginning on a separate page. Use it to practise PDF loading, chunking, semantic retrieval, and source-page citations in your RAG project.

Important note

The organization and policies are fictional and are for technical practice only. They should not be treated as real company rules.

1. Overview and Purpose

Purpose

This handbook explains the fictional Northstar Digital Services workplace policies. It is designed as sample content for testing PDF ingestion, retrieval, and question-answering systems. It is not legal or employment advice.

Who is covered

These guidelines apply to full-time employees in the company's India offices unless a section says otherwise. Contractors, interns, and employees in other countries should confirm their applicable terms with Human Resources (HR).

Policy owners

HR owns leave and workplace policies. Finance owns reimbursement rules. IT Security owns device, access, and information-security standards. Managers explain team procedures but cannot silently override a written policy.

When unsure

Read the relevant section and contact the named team if an exception or interpretation is needed. Do not assume a request is approved until the approval is recorded.

Practical reminder

If the situation is unclear, consult the appropriate policy owner rather than assuming an exception or inventing a rule.

2. Annual Leave

Annual entitlement

Eligible full-time employees receive 20 days of annual leave per calendar year. The leave year runs from 1 January through 31 December. Employees joining during the year should ask HR to confirm prorated entitlement.

Carry-forward

A maximum of 5 unused annual-leave days may be carried into the next year, subject to local law and the employee's contract. Carried days should normally be used by 31 March.

Request and approval

Submit planned leave through the HR portal at least five working days before the first day away. Leave is not approved until the manager records approval in the portal. Report urgent absences as soon as practical.

Handover

For absences of three or more working days, prepare a handover listing open work, deadlines, key contacts, and urgent risks. Managers should consider team coverage fairly.

Practical reminder

If the situation is unclear, consult the appropriate policy owner rather than assuming an exception or inventing a rule.

3. Sick Leave and Public Holidays

Sick leave

Employees who are unwell should notify their manager before their normal start time where practical and record the absence in the HR portal when able. HR can explain documentation requirements for longer absences.

Medical privacy

Share only medical documentation required by HR. Managers should not request unnecessary personal medical details. Medical records must be handled confidentially by authorized staff.

Public holidays

The company publishes an annual holiday calendar for each office. The applicable calendar depends on the employee's assigned work location. Ask HR how a public holiday during annual leave is counted.

Return to work

After an extended absence, an employee may coordinate a return-to-work plan with HR and their manager. Adjustments should be documented and shared only with people who need the information.

Practical reminder

If the situation is unclear, consult the appropriate policy owner rather than assuming an exception or inventing a rule.

4. Work From Home and Attendance

Remote-work allowance

Eligible employees may work from home up to 2 days per week with manager agreement. Role requirements, customer commitments, and team coverage may affect approval.

Advance notice

Inform the manager at least one working day before a planned remote-work day and update the team calendar. Communicate last-minute changes promptly.

Availability

Remote employees should be reachable during agreed working hours, attend scheduled meetings, and keep their status accurate. Flexibility can be agreed with the manager when coverage permits.

Work environment

Use a reasonably private workspace, protect screens from being viewed by others, and avoid discussing confidential information in public places. Do not use public Wi-Fi for sensitive work unless an approved secure connection is active.

Practical reminder

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5. Internet and Home-Office Reimbursement

Monthly internet limit

Eligible employees may claim up to ■1,000 per month for home internet expenses. Reimbursement cannot exceed the actual eligible cost paid.

Required evidence

Attach a valid service-provider bill and proof of payment. The employee's name or registered service address should reasonably connect the bill to the employee.

Submission deadline

Submit claims before the last day of each month. Late claims may move to the next processing cycle or be declined under finance rules.

Not covered

Entertainment subscriptions, personal mobile purchases, router upgrades, and late-payment fees are not covered unless Finance grants written exception approval.

Review process

Finance checks eligibility, supporting evidence, duplicate submissions, and the monthly cap. Never submit the same bill more than once.

Practical reminder

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6. Business Travel and Expenses

Approval before booking

Business travel must be approved by the manager before tickets or accommodation are purchased. Include business purpose, dates, destination, and expected cost.

Reasonable costs

Choose reasonably priced transport and accommodation that meet business and safety needs. Exceptions to standard limits must be approved in writing before the cost is incurred.

Expense deadline

Submit travel expense claims within 30 calendar days after the trip ends. Receipts are required for hotel, transport, meals, and other reimbursable expenses where normally available.

Accommodation

Hotel costs are reimbursable only for approved business travel and dates. Personal extensions, minibar purchases, entertainment, and family-member costs are not covered.

Changes

Notify the manager and travel coordinator promptly when plans change. Refunds and credits belong to the company when it paid for the original booking.

Practical reminder

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7. Workplace Conduct and Inclusion

Professional conduct

Communicate respectfully, avoid harassment and discrimination, and cooperate with reasonable work-related requests. Concerns can be reported to HR or the confidential reporting channel.

Inclusive meetings

Share agendas when practical, invite relevant participants, and make space for different viewpoints. Avoid interrupting, insulting, or excluding colleagues.

Conflicts of interest

Disclose situations where personal, financial, or family interests could affect business decisions. The company will assess safeguards; disclosure does not automatically mean misconduct.

Gifts and hospitality

Do not offer or accept gifts that could influence a business decision. Disclose anything beyond a modest customary token to the manager and Compliance for review.

Practical reminder

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8. Learning, Performance, and Equipment

Learning support

Discuss development goals with the manager and use approved learning resources. Training involving paid subscriptions or travel requires normal budget approval.

Performance conversations

Managers should provide timely feedback, explain expectations, and document agreed development actions. Employees may request clarification when goals are unclear.

Company equipment

Company laptops, access cards, and peripherals are for authorized work. Protect equipment from loss or damage and report incidents promptly to IT.

Return of assets

When employment ends or equipment is replaced, return company assets according to HR and IT instructions. Local processes may require an asset-return checklist.

Practical reminder

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9. Privacy, Records, and Reporting

Personal information

Access personal information only when needed for assigned responsibilities. Do not copy personal data to personal email or unapproved storage.

Record accuracy

Expense claims, timesheets, leave records, and business reports must be accurate. Correct mistakes promptly and never knowingly create a false record.

Reporting concerns

Report suspected policy breaches, safety issues, fraud, or data exposure promptly to the relevant team. Include facts and avoid unnecessary speculation.

No retaliation

Employees who raise a concern in good faith or assist an investigation should not face retaliation. Deliberately false reports may be reviewed under the conduct process.

Practical reminder

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10. Frequently Asked Questions and Contacts

How many annual-leave days are provided?

The standard entitlement is 20 days per calendar year for eligible full-time employees. A maximum of 5 unused days may be carried forward, subject to applicable rules.

What is the internet reimbursement limit?

The standard limit is ■1,000 per month, supported by a valid bill and proof of payment. Submit claims before month-end.

How early should planned leave be requested?

Normally at least five working days in advance. Manager approval in the HR portal is required.

How many work-from-home days are allowed?

Eligible employees may work from home up to 2 days per week with manager agreement and one working day's notice.

Who should I contact?

Contact HR for leave and workplace questions, Finance for expense claims, IT Service Desk for device and access issues, and the manager for team scheduling. These contacts are fictional.

Practical reminder

If the situation is unclear, consult the appropriate policy owner rather than assuming an exception or inventing a rule.